

Portuguese in Massachusetts

Linguistic attitudes, social networks and language maintenance

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In the state of Massachusetts, Portuguese is the second most spoken foreign language after Spanish and the dense population of Portuguese speakers gives this community vitality. This paper analyzes the linguistic attitudes of a group of twenty Portuguese men and women, from the island of Saint Michael, Azores, who have lived on the eastern coast of Massachusetts for more than fifteen years. Some important factors that have been linked to language maintenance and the prevention of language attrition are positive attitudes, socio-cultural factors and social networks. Using the social networks framework, we further discuss the implications that language attitudes may have on language maintenance within this community. We conclude that linguistic attitudes continue to be a key factor in preventing language loss and promoting ethnic pride, which ultimately benefit language maintenance.

Keywords: language attitudes, Portuguese in Massachusetts, language maintenance, social networks

Introduction

In the Commonwealth of Massachusetts, a state located in New England at the northeastern corner of the United States, 21% of the total population declares that they speak a language other than English at home, a number slightly above the average for the whole nation (20%). According to the American Community Survey 2009–2013, Portuguese is spoken by 2.9% of the total population in the state. This number makes Portuguese the second most spoken foreign language in Massachusetts, preceded only by Spanish (Carvalho, 2010).

A positive attitude towards one's minority language has been considered one of the most important factors to prevent linguistic attrition and promote ethnic pride of language use (Anderson-Mejías, Mejías, & Carlson, 2002, 2003; Preston, 1999,

among others). However, some scholars did not find clear links between measures of attitude and L1 attrition (Yağmur, 1997) and others showed that pragmatic and ideological motivation to emigrate along with ensuing attitudes were clearly linked to L1 attrition (Ben-Rafael & Schmid, 2007). Cherciov (2013, p. 730) establishes that “a positive attitude is not in and of itself a guarantee against language attrition,” but “a positive attitude is the prime factor in determining the motivation necessary to engage in language maintenance efforts.” Moreover, Winford (2003) affirms that socio-cultural factors, such as speakers’ ideologies and attitudes towards their varieties are also relevant because they can supersede any internal resistance to linguistic change and/or attrition.

This paper analyzes the attitude toward the minority language of a group of twenty Portuguese speakers and the importance that their social networks can have in language maintenance. The participants represent first and second-generation speakers who are from the island of São Miguel, Azores. Those who are first-generation speakers have lived on the eastern coast of Massachusetts for more than fifteen years. The participants who represent second-generation speakers are those who were born and raised in the United States but have at least one parent who is from São Miguel. The main goal of this paper is threefold as it examines (i) the attitudes and use towards language and language use of both English and Portuguese, (ii) how social networks of immigrants can render positive attitudes concerning the ethnic language, and (iii) what impact these attitudes and social networks may have in maintaining the Portuguese language in the area. The data collected from each participant reflect a combination of written questions that were used to convey the attitudes of participants towards language and language use (more than 80 questions), and a one-hour semi-structured sociolinguistic interview. Given the fact that each methodology has certain limitations and advantages (Cherciov, 2013; González Martínez, 2008), a combination of both questionnaires and interviews was used as the most appropriate procedure to uncover linguistic practices that serve to predict language maintenance within the group. This study serves to contribute to the general discussion about the importance of language attitudes on language maintenance and patterns of language use.

The organization of this study is as follows: first, we briefly describe the history of Portuguese immigration in Massachusetts and explore the main social and linguistic characteristics of these immigrants. We then present a review of previous studies with respect to language attitudes, acculturation, and language maintenance. The research questions considered in this study are later discussed along with the main hypothesis and methodology used to collect the data. We later present the results of this study, which leads to the discussion of the issue of language maintenance within the Portuguese community in eastern Massachusetts. Finally, we present the conclusions that summarize our findings.

Portuguese in Eastern Massachusetts

Portuguese speakers in Eastern Massachusetts are mainly from the Azorean archipelago and mainland Portugal.¹ Initially, migration to the United States was attributed to religious purposes and work opportunities, particularly in the whaling and fishing industries and later the textile industries. During the last half of the nineteenth century, the textile industries superseded other jobs and as a result the Portuguese created social networks that later benefited the Portuguese newcomers. According to Williams (1982, p. 13)

Few in number in the 1850s, Azorean mill workers gradually increased in the '60s and '70s and paved the way for their countrymen who poured into this area in subsequent decades. When the young immigrant from the Azores stepped ashore in New England in the early 1870s, his compatriots had already established themselves in a number of occupational niches and were, in effect, holding the doors open to their fellow countrymen.

The arrival of the Azorean Portuguese immigrants to New England intensified in the late twentieth century. The industrial development in America stirred hopes, and possibilities, which resulted in the first wave of Portuguese immigration. In the latter half of the twentieth century, the second and largest wave of immigration reached its highest peak in 1970. Furthermore, De Sá, Pacheco and Farrar (2011, p. 3) explain,

It began with the passage of the Azorean Refugee Acts of 1958, which allowed families affected by the eruption of the Capelinhos volcano to settle in the United States, but its major cause was the passage of the Immigration and Naturalization Act of 1965, which abolished the national quotas and introduced a system based on family reunification.

According to Mira (1998) and Amaral (1978), Portuguese immigrants densely settled in the states of New England. The record of the first US census dates to 1790, and the data retrieved indicates that the Portuguese represented an estimated 24,000 people. In the city of New Bedford alone, there was a prominent rise in terms of immigration within a mere century. Vermette (1998) alludes to this increase of population and states that it “went from 2,213 in 1790 to 33,293 in 1885 in part reflecting the presence of these Portuguese newcomers” (p. 216). New Bedford represented one of the seven New England Azorean Portuguese communities that were established in Massachusetts. The documentary *Saudade*, known as *Nostalgia*, by

1. For more information about Portuguese immigration data please see Ribeiro, 1982; Silva, 1969, and Williams, 2005.

Bela Feldman Bianco was made in 1991 to document the strong presence, experience and culture of the Portuguese in the United States, particularly in the city of New Bedford. In the documentary, Professor Frank F. Sousa states, “Today 60% of New Bedford’s 110,000 inhabitants are Portuguese descent. Portuguese language, commerce, and culture dominate.” Despite New Bedford’s dense population of Portuguese communities, its neighboring city of Fall River also received a positive influx of Portuguese immigration. According to Dion (2003, p. 19),

In 1970, the city received 700 Portuguese. For an aging industrial city whose population had been declining for much of the century, the effect of new immigration was positive, immediate, and immense. Fall River would never be the same... The new immigrants revitalized a Portuguese community that hadn’t received a great number of new immigrants since the early part of the century. Portuguese restaurants, bars, churches, social clubs, civic and cultural organizations and the great religious feasts were all revived by the newcomers.

The influx of Portuguese immigrants who settled in New England during the last two centuries, preserved and formed tight knit Portuguese communities. This resulted in their unwavering strong presence in the state of Massachusetts. Of the total number of Portuguese in the United States, 31% of this population resides in the state of Massachusetts (Carvalho, 2010). The most recent information obtained from the US Census indicates that 12.4% of the Portuguese population of Bristol County (Figure 1) uses and maintains the Portuguese language at home.² And while the percentage of people who claim to speak another language in the state of Massachusetts is slightly above the nation average (22.1 and 21% respectively), this percentage rises to 33.4% in the city of Fall River, one of Bristol County (Census Bureau).

Figure 2 represents the 2011 Language Mapper for the state of Massachusetts, which shows information that was retrieved from the 2010 US census. The dots in the figure are representative of one hundred people and show the densely-populated areas where the Portuguese settled.³

2. Bristol County includes cities such as Taunton, Attleboro, Fall River and New Bedford. It is also part of the Providence-Warwick, RI-MA Metropolitan Statistical Area, as well as the Boston-Worcester-Providence, MA-RI-NH-CT combined statistical area.

3. The demographics can be accessed at <https://www.census.gov/hhes/socdemo/language/data/language_map.html>

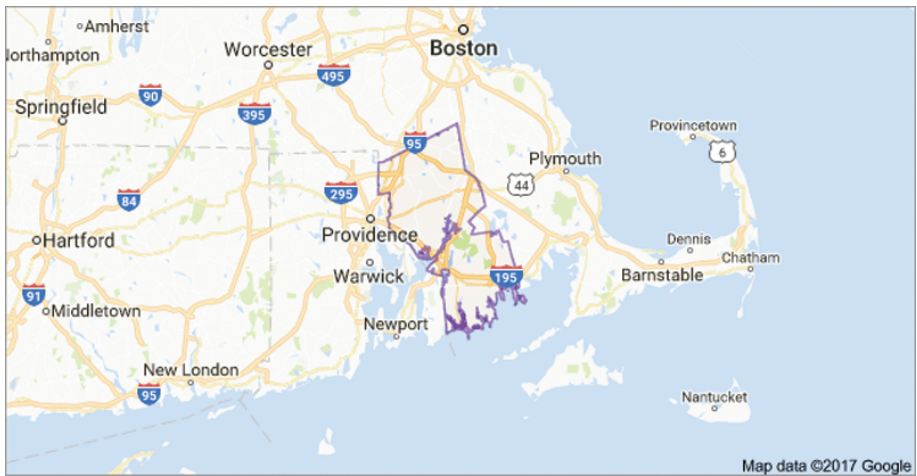


Figure 1. Bristol County, MA. Source: Google Maps

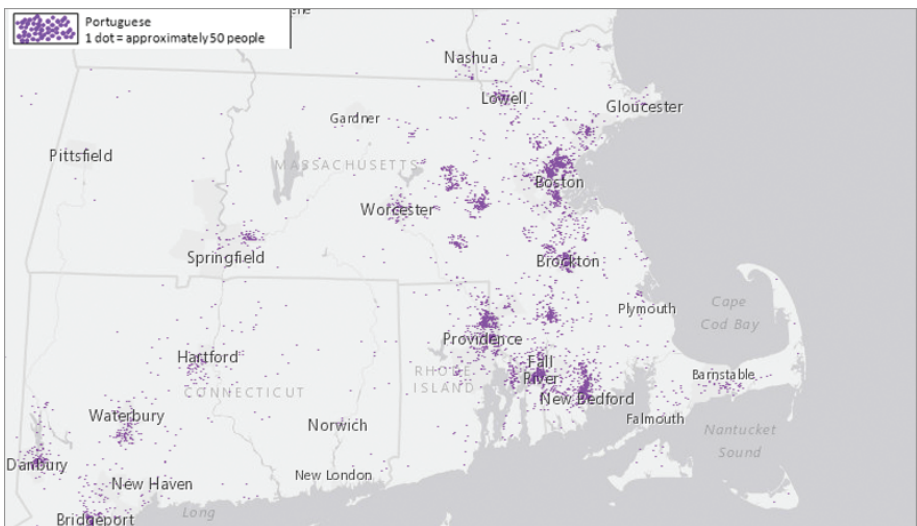


Figure 2. 2011 Language Mapper of Massachusetts. Source: US Census

Table 1 presents the demographics of Bristol county which shows its linguistic diversity and predominance of the Portuguese language.⁴

4. The source of this information can be retrieved at <<http://www.census.gov/data/tables/2013/demo/2009-2013-lang-tables.html>>

Table 1. Languages Spoken at Home and Ability to Speak English for the Population 5 Years and Over for Bristol County, MA: 2009–2013

	Number of speakers	Speak English less than “Very Well”
Population 5 years and over	519,447	41,848
Speak only English at home	412,567	(X)
Speak a language other than English at home	106,880	41,848
Portuguese and Portuguese Creole	62,323	25,401
Portuguese	62,325	25,400
Spanish and Spanish Creole	22,451	8,994
Spanish	22,450	8,995
Other Indo-European languages	12,822	3,782
Asian and Pacific Island languages	6,742	3,117
All other languages	2,540	554

The second wave of Portuguese migration in 1961 was the result of economic reasons as people pursued employment opportunities to improve their economic situation and to also reunite with other members of their family who had already immigrated to the United States.

In a multicultural setting such as those we encounter in the cities of Fall River and New Bedford, “choice and use of language are determined by a multitude of factors that are difficult to discern and to group, as each individual comes with a different set of idiosyncratic likes and dislikes based on yet another multitude of factors” (Stoessel, 2002, p. 94). Indeed, language maintenance or loss depend on a mix of factors that drives immigrants to use or reject their mother tongue and adopt the language of the host country. Therefore, the existence of ethnic social networks that support the immigrants’ language maintenance is of vital importance.

Fall River and New Bedford

Several businesses in Fall River and New Bedford contribute to a Portuguese atmosphere such as *Portugalia Marketplace*, *Mello’s Chouriço and Linguiça*, *Amaral’s Central Market*, *Chaves Market*, *Seabra*, and *New Bedford Salchicharia*. Restaurants and bakeries that have also prospered in Fall River and New Bedford include, *Estoril*, *Caldeiras*, *Clipper*, *Academica*, *Cinderella*, *Sagres*, *Afonso’s Bakery*, *Modern Pontes*, *Rose Bakery*, *Tony’s Bakery*, *Cunha’s Bakery*, *Cotali Mar*, and *Café Mimo* just to name a few. The sense of Portuguese customs and habits has been noticed by Almeida (2008, p. 358) who states,

It was possible to eat in various Portuguese restaurants; buy from Portuguese bakeries, markets, furniture stores and automobile stands; every weekend it was possible to attend events in the Portuguese associations; mark your calendar with celebrations throughout the entire year, attend masses celebrated in Portuguese, in Portuguese churches; it was easy to participate in social organizations; attend concerts by Portuguese artists; see television and read Portuguese newspapers, from local to Lisbon or Azorean sources; attend soccer games of local Portuguese teams; consult a Portuguese doctor, go to stores, hospitals and government offices, including police, where it is possible to be served by employees who speak Portuguese. Island life was recreated with vitality, flexibility, enthusiasm, nostalgia, and cooperation. Thousands of volunteers dedicated hours to maintain Portuguese associations and help the church.⁵

Catholic churches have also been of vital importance in the lives of the northeastern Portuguese communities. Portuguese people have preserved their religious beliefs and are known to have built several Portuguese Catholic churches in New Bedford, Fall River and Providence since the second half of the nineteenth century. Catholic churches in these communities not only provide spiritual comfort to their members, but also play an important role in ethnic education. The *Igreja do Espírito Santo* was initially opened as a mission in 1904 and became a church in 1910; in this same year, the “First Portuguese Catholic grammar school in America” was inaugurated on the second floor of the building.⁶ According to the school’s current website, 70% of the students are bilingual and 90% are of Portuguese descent. Moreover, “children are instructed in the Portuguese language in order to help them function and serve the Portuguese-American community.” According to Lasagabaster (2014), the use of the regional, co-official languages as means of instruction in multilingual contexts fosters positive attitudes towards these languages as he observed in Spain.

In the cities considered in this paper, education in the ethnic language is not only available at private schools but also in the public schools. B.M.C. Durfee High School in Fall River states on its website

Language is our connector to the world and to our community. As the world becomes more interdependent, and as American citizenship means world citizenship, our students will need to communicate across cultural and linguistic boundaries. Five years of French, Spanish, and Portuguese are offered.

In addition, there are also courses offered for heritage speakers in Portuguese and Spanish.⁷

5. Translation of the original text written in Portuguese.

6. Data available at <<https://www.espiritosantoschool.org/history-mission-2/>>

7. Data available at <https://resources.finalsite.net/images/v1537546195/fallriverschoolsorg/hjicouzcgly7rzp6irlu/2018-2019_Program_of_Studies_2-27-18.pdf>

Also, New Bedford public high school offers four years of Spanish and Portuguese language courses. However, only Spanish offers advanced placement (AP) classes. Nevertheless, the school also has courses for heritage speakers in Portuguese and school calendars are also offered in the Portuguese language.⁸

Besides churches and schools, the Portuguese also remained connected through social media. Two newspapers, *The Portuguese Times* and *O Jornal* were published in order to disseminate Portuguese news, culture and events to the Portuguese communities. The Portuguese also established radio stations such as *Rádio Voz do Emigrante* 1400 amplitude modulation (AM) and WJFD 97.3, a Portuguese radio station that is transmitted from New Bedford in a frequency modulation broadcasting (FM). Moreover, *RTP*, the *International Portuguese Radio Television*, and *Channel 20* are two Portuguese television channels that are aired in New Bedford and Fall River. In addition to informing the community of current news, Portuguese mass media allows the Portuguese diaspora to maintain a spirit of solidarity, reinforcing ethnic identity and group membership.

Literature review

Although Portuguese speakers constitute the second largest linguistic minority group within the state of Massachusetts following Spanish, very few studies have been conducted on this particular group and none have focused on language attitudes.

The term attitude refers to “an evaluative orientation to a social object of some sort” such as language (Garrett, 2010, p. 20); or in other words, it can be “briefly defined as a construct underlying the feelings people have about their own language or the languages of others” (Cherciov, 2013, p. 717). Linguistic attitudes have been considered to be among the most influential in terms of first language loss, attrition and/or language maintenance. However, studies have found dissimilar results when studying linguistic loss and attrition. Some researchers could not find strong connections between attitude and L1 attrition (Yağmur, 1997), while others revealed that attitudes resulting from life events sturdily influenced attrition and loss (Schmid, 2002). Moreover, pragmatic vs. ideological motivation can generate attitudes that are linked to L1 maintenance or attrition (Ben-Rafael & Schmid, 2007). Nevertheless, Cherciov (2013) points out,

8. School calendars can be downloaded at: <http://www.newbedfordschools.org/parents_students/school_calendars_hours/2019_-_2020_school_calendars>

A closer examination of these studies yields a noteworthy pattern: those studies that relied on questionnaires (Hulsen, 2000; Yağmur, 1997) seemed to find no straight correlations between attitude and L1 performance, while the studies that used interviews (Ben-Rafael & Schmid, 2007; Schmid, 2002) established a clearer link between the two. (p. 717)

For that reason, Cherciov (2013) claims that a combination of methodological approaches in the study of language attrition is better suited to capture the nonlinearity of attitude and its impact on language attrition and loss.

Pascual y Cabo's (2015) study of Cuban-American attitudes toward the Spanish language, conducted in the Miami-Dade area, analyzes the attitudes of 41 Cuban-origin migrants of three different generations. The study reveals that despite the fact that the groups are homogenous, there are latent differences among them. Such differences are "a consequence of the materialization of prejudice and negative attitudes towards the newcomers" (2015, p. 373). The reduced communication between the groups "seems to point in the direction of a cultural shift towards mainstream American monoculturalism and consequently to a plausible language loss" (Pascual y Cabo, 2015, p. 400).

In a multivariate analysis exploring language attrition among German bilinguals in Canada and the Netherlands, Schmid and Dusseldorp (2010) found that

While the predictor variables, measured through questionnaires and the Attitude and Motivation Test Battery, fall into several factor groups – such as identification and affiliation with the L1, attitude towards the L1, and exposure to the L1 – the predictive power of these factor groups plays no significant role for the outcome of the first language attrition process. (Cherciov, 2013, p. 719)

Similar conclusions were reached by Yağmur's (1997, 2004) study of language attrition and shift among Turkish bilinguals in Australia. Yağmur's research is based on the Ethnolinguistic Vitality Theory (EVT) introduced by Giles, Bourhis and Taylor (1977), and its accompanying instrument, the Subjective Ethnolinguistic Vitality Questionnaire.

The Ethnolinguistic Vitality Theory

The Ethnolinguistic Vitality Theory (EVT) is a method by which sociocultural factors impacting the strength of minority languages within and across various contexts can be examined (Rubinstein-Avila, 2005). Linguistic vitality is dependent on factors such as demographics, status of the minority language within and outside the community, institutional support and a combination of control factors, such as English-only legislations (Barker et al., 2001). Measures of strengths

and weaknesses in each of these areas allow us to classify ethnolinguistic groups as having low, medium, or high vitality. Low vitality groups are more susceptible to change and as a result assimilate linguistically and may not be considered a distinctive collective group (Bourhis et al., 1981). Conversely, high vitality groups are likely to maintain their language and distinctive cultural traits in multilingual settings. Studies done on the ethnolinguistic vitality of immigrant communities in a variety of contexts reveal that stable bilingualism is rare beyond the third generation (Garcia, 2003; Portes & Hao, 1998). Nevertheless, even when communities may hold oral maintenance of their ethnic language in high regard, print literacy in the minority language may not be viewed as particularly useful (Garcia, 2003). According to Rubinstein-Avila (2005), Tse's (2001) study of heritage language maintenance and literacy development among young adults in the U.S. from a variety of linguistic backgrounds reveals that native oral bilinguals do not necessarily develop print-literacy skills in their heritage language.

Recent studies on attitudes and language maintenance using the EVT, however, have documented the possible limitations of this framework (Yağmur, 2011; Yağmur & Ehala, 2011), given its inability to account for the actual dynamics in language maintenance. One of the most serious criticisms is that EVT only focuses on mainstream institutions while ethnic minority institutions are ignored, which results in underestimation of the actual vitality of ethnic groups (Yağmur, 2011). Nevertheless, despite these methodological and theoretical issues, "the notion of EVT has great heuristic value and it has been used as a reference point in several related fields" (Yağmur & Ehala, 2011, p. 106).

Social networks

Another framework that has been useful to analyze the relationship between attitudes and language maintenance is the social network theory. A social network can be defined as "informal relationships contracted by an individual" (Milroy, 1987, p. 78). Furthermore, it is an abstract concept introduced by Milroy (1987 [1980], p. 78) which refers to the person of a community that engages with other individuals within the same group and as a result creates a social connection. Hence, the group consists of a primary person who is considered the leader and has particular ties to different people from different domains of life.

Moreover, Milroy (2001, p. 5) explains that, "variation in the structure of different individuals' personal social networks will systematically affect both the vitality of the community language and the speech community's vulnerability to language shift." Following this line of research, Zentella (1994) shows that code-switching among Puerto Ricans living in New York is social-network related.

Given that in multilingual language-contact situations choice and use of language are determined by a multitude of factors (Stoessel, 2002), social networks of minority language speakers become relevant as they provide a safe linguistic environment where minority language users can practice their ethnic language. Research by Montes-Alcalá and Sweetnich (2014), suggests that positive attitudes towards one's own minority language as well as having supportive social networks help to provide ample opportunities for people to practice their ethnic language. Furthermore, these useful strategies can also serve to stop or prevent the process of a linguistic shift towards the majority language. This is seen in Velázquez's (2012) study of fifteen Mexican American families in El Paso, Texas. Velázquez uses a Social Network analysis and finds that Spanish transmission is highly influenced by the linguistic competence of the mother and her participation in networks where Spanish shares a sense of identity.

The cities of Fall River and New Bedford, Massachusetts, have a long history of Portuguese settlements that has allowed migrants to create an atmosphere that reproduces the life of the Azorean archipelago where immigrants are able to speak their native language, indulge in the Portuguese gastronomy, study, practice their faith, listen to the radio and socialize in Portuguese. Almeida (1987) uses the term, *L(USA)land* to refer to the visibility of the Portuguese diaspora. According to Almeida, Portuguese communities have recreated the Azores in their new home in the United States, particularly in the cities of Fall River and New Bedford, Massachusetts. Hence, social networks play an important role in the community and have an impact on its ethnolinguistic vitality "and therefore the likelihood to which the community will succumb to language shift" (Rubinstein-Avila, 2005, p. 878).

Hulsen, de Bot, and Weltens's study (2002) examines language maintenance and loss among Dutch migrants in New Zealand and concludes that those migrants with more language contacts in familial and friendship networks had a greater maintenance of the ethnic language than did those with fewer contacts in that sphere, concluding that "language use in these migrant networks relates to language shift and language processing" (2002, p. 28). In a study with ten isolated migrant women, Stoessel (2002, p. 124) concludes that a social network group is essential in language maintenance.

Social networks are, therefore, of particular relevance in studying language maintenance, and the social network analysis (SNA) serves as a tool to study "the social structure that individuals and entities construct through interaction" (Velázquez, 2012, p. 2).

The sections that follow are dedicated to the research questions, methodology, and discussion of the results of this study.

Methodology

Goals and hypotheses

The main goal of this study is to analyze the role of language attitudes and social networks of language use and language maintenance as currently portrayed by a group of twenty Portuguese men and women, including first and second-generation speakers, from the island of São Miguel, Azores.

The present study originated from previous studies (Ben-Rafael & Schmid, 2007; Cherciov, 2013; Crochran et al., 1990; Hulsen et al., 2002; Stoessel, 1998; Yağmur, 1997) regarding language attitudes and social networks. The attitudes and language usage of second-generation speakers of Portuguese are also examined to determine if they correspond with those of first-generation migrants regarding their social networks, and if otherwise, to what extent first and second-generation speakers of Portuguese differ from each other. Results of a weaker social network system would suggest assimilation to the mainstream society and would show signs of language shift. In relation to this, examining the correlation between linguistic attitudes and language use in the different domains of language use would also serve to evaluate what impact they have (if any) on language maintenance in regards to first and second-generation speakers of Portuguese.

Our hypotheses are the following:

- A. *First and second-generation social networks.* If participants are able to speak Portuguese, and both groups show high proficiency in their use of the language we will corroborate which of the following is at the base of high proficiency in both groups:
 - H₀: First and second-generation participants share the same social networks;
 - H₁: First and second-generation participants do not share the same social networks
- B. *Language attitudes.* Positive language attitudes are correlated with the use of the Portuguese language in different domains. Therefore, we assume the following:
 - H₀: Positive linguistic attitudes towards one's language are related to the use of Portuguese within all social domains.
 - H₁: Positive linguistic attitudes towards one's language are not related to the use of Portuguese within any social domain.

Procedure

The results we present here came from the analysis of data collected through the use of interviews, surveys and questionnaires from twenty participants, eleven first-generation Portuguese immigrants (five women and six men from the island of St. Michael) and nine second-generation Portuguese American speakers (five women and four men). They were recruited from the metropolitan areas of Fall River and New Bedford, in eastern Massachusetts via snowball sampling. Their age ranges between eighteen and eighty-two years old. The median for the second-generation participants was twenty years old and for the first-generation participants it was sixty-one. The coding and age of both first and second-generation speakers can be seen in Table 2.

Table 2. Codification and age of the participants in this study

First-generation participants				Second-generation participants			
Females		Males		Females		Males	
Code	Age	Code	Age	Code	Age	Code	Age
PF2	63	PM1	67	PF7	18	PM2	18
PF5	53	PM3	66	PF9	21	PM6	20
PF6	50	PM4	42	PF10	20	PM9	26
PF8	61	PM5	61	PF12	27	PM10	19
PF11	48	PM7	53	PF13	23	–	–
–	–	PM8	82	–	–	–	–

To be eligible for participation in this study, participants had to identify themselves as being of “Portuguese origin.” Some researchers have pointed out the importance of ethnic support within a group as an essential factor for language maintenance (Conklin & Lourie, 1983; Giles et al., 1977; Stoessel, 2002). On the contrary, a lack of unity and encouragement from minority communities ultimately results in a shift toward the language of the majority group, which will supersede as a result of the pressure from the main society. Consequently, participants in this study answered a demographic survey which included information regarding how they establish their social networks and their use of the language. They were then prompted to fill an attitudinal questionnaire and, finally, a one-hour interview was conducted with each participant. To better understand the ties that bind participants to their social network each participant was asked his/her primary language of exchange in each particular domain he/she uses and what language he/she recalls using in the past.

Based on previous research (Crochran et al., 1990; Hulsen et al., 2002; Stoessel, 1998), three dimensions of migrants’ social networks were analyzed: relational

characteristics, structural properties and location in space and time. Relational characteristics included questions regarding the nature of the relationship (family, friends, colleagues) and the intensity of the interaction (always, frequently, seldom, never). Based on this information, the network was divided into a primary network (most influential contacts) and a non-primary network. Structural properties took into account the size of the total network and the size of both primary and non-primary networks. Location in space and time referred to the geographical and temporal characteristics of the network (Hulsen et al., 2002), such as relatives in Portugal, trips to the Azores, etc.

The questions provided information from the participants and included the following: the language or languages that the participants currently speak at home, with friends, at work and outside the house. The language or languages that the participants spoke at home as a child, and among their friends. Their language preference when using an ATM machine, reading instructions to assemble something recently bought, or when seeking assistance was also important information to obtain. Furthermore, information regarding previous studies in Portuguese and trips taken to Portuguese speaking countries were also questions included in the survey. Each participant also specified when he or she learned English and Portuguese by indicating at birth, early childhood or during his/her adolescent or adult years.

The interview was followed by a questionnaire and a survey. The collection of oral data represented the spontaneous and natural speech of this Portuguese community and the observer's paradox was avoided for the interviewer was also a member of the community. Collected data allowed us to gather information regarding the use of language among friends at work, at school, at church and outside the home.⁹ Furthermore, language choices and attitudes regarding the Portuguese and English languages, as well as knowledge of any other languages were also considered. Results discussed in this paper are limited and related to the attitudinal survey and the participants' social networks. Some excerpts from the interviews will be presented to exemplify the discussion when necessary.

9. Labov states "the aim of linguistic research in the community must be to find out how people talk when they are not being systematically observed; yet we can only obtain this data by systematic observation" (1972, p. 209). The purpose of linguistic research is to observe the linguistic phenomenon under scrutiny in order to maintain objectivity and avoid bias with data analysis.

Results and discussion

Social networks play an important role in an individual's linguistic and cultural socialization (Stoessel, 2002) as they may influence language maintenance and shift. Therefore, it is crucial to understand the kind of ties that bind participants of each generation to their social network and determine the strength of these ties. If both groups have similar behaviors, it is assumed that the social networks that have helped to maintain ethnic language use among first-generation immigrants will also provide second-generation Portuguese Americans an environment where they can practice and maintain their ethnic language.

To test whether the social network of both groups is equivalent or not, a one-way Analysis of Variance (ANOVA) was performed and generation was considered the single factor. Results presented in Table 3 show that the F critical value is smaller than the F value; hence, the hypothesis that social networks are equal in both groups must be rejected. The difference between the two generational groups is significant as p is smaller than 0.005.

Table 3. ANOVA analysis, comparison of social networks between generations

Social network comparison			
	1 Generation	2 Generation	
Family	4.6	3	
Friends	4.5	3	
Work	3.5	3	
Church	4	3	
School	3.5	3	
<i>Std. deviation</i>	0.52631	0	
df: 8 <i>p-level</i> 0.0025			
	<i>F</i>	<i>F crit</i>	ω^2
Variation between groups	18.77978	5.31766	0.64003

To control for type I errors (that is the incorrect rejection of a true hypothesis), a Tukey's post-hoc test was performed maintaining alpha at the .005 level. Results from this test are illustrated in Table 4 below and confirm that differentiation between both generations is significant.

Table 4. Tukey's Honest Significant Difference (HSD) test

Groups	Difference	Test statistics	p-level	Significant
1 Generation vs. 2 Generation	1.02	6.12859	0.00261	Yes

From the results displayed above we must conclude that first and second-generation participants are not connected with social networks in the same way, and second-generation speakers seem to have a weaker bond with the community than their parents, as the mean for their social network is three, while the mean for the first generation is four. However, the question that arises is whether second-generation speakers are eventually prone to suffer language loss and cultural accommodation since they do not have social networks strongly tied to their ethnic community. Moreover, we must also inquire about the temporal characteristics of second-generation participants' social networks and ask how they perceive their social networks with respect to the past and whether this difference has a correlation with their current linguistic attitude and language use practices.

Second-generation Portuguese migrants

Social networks not only provide a safe environment for speakers to practice their language, but also require people to respond to them as individuals, reacting to the pressures of a social environment, and also interacting with it (McCall & Simmons, 1978; Stoessel, 2002). Second-generation participants have all answered that language is important for them to express their identity, and have shown positive attitudes towards their minority language. Further analysis is needed to determine if their Portuguese social networks are weakened with respect to the past and if so, there is a need to scrutinize how and at what level. Table 5 shows a summary of the results in terms of the past and current use of Portuguese for each participant in different social settings.¹⁰

Results confirm, as many studies have stated, that there is disparity among second-generation speakers. However, and most importantly, Table 5 shows that the mean of all of the categories has increased in terms of the importance of language use with the exception of family. According to Stoessel (1998, 2002), people who frequently use their minority language in non-primary networks and have a strong connection with their home country show a high ratio of language maintenance and are, therefore, "strong maintainers" (Hulsen et al., 2002, p. 31). In our data, every social network domain among second-generation members shows an increasing number that coincides with the participants' willingness to practice their language.

Family is the only domain that shows a lower mean in the present times and is attributed to the following reasons: (a) some of the grandparents of the participants are deceased, and (b) some of the participants have partners who do not speak Portuguese.

10. The category family includes mother, father, grandparents, siblings, partner and children.

Table 5. Past and present Portuguese social networks in 2nd generation participants

Participants	Family		Friends		Church		Work		School	
	Past	Pres	Past	Pres	Past	Pres	Past	Pres	Past	Pres
PF7	3.5	3	2	3	4	4	–	–	2	3
PF9	4.6	3.7	3	4	2	1	–	4	3	–
PF10	3.2	2.3	1	1	1	3	–	1	1	3
PF12	4.8	4.4	4	4	4	4	–	4	4	–
PF13	4.8	4.3	4	4	4	4	–	4	4	4
PM2	3	2.1	1	2	3	3	–	3	1	3
PM6	2.8	2.4	1	1f	1	1	–	1	1	2
PM9	1.6	3	2	4	1	4	–	4	2	4
PM10	3	2.6	2	3	1	3	–	4	1	1
MEAN	3.4	3.1	2.2	2.8	2.3	2.8	–	3	2.1	2.8
SD	1.07	0.91	1.2	1.35	1.41	1.24	–	1.41	1.26	1.16
Variance	1.15	0.84	1.44	1.83	2	1.55	–	2	1.61	1.36

Second-generation participants also have a strong connection with the Portuguese culture and community as they participate in the social life of the city. They identify themselves as teachers, students, and businessmen who took over their parents' business; others are responsible to broadcast about their culture as this participant's excerpt shows:

I: *Bem, tenho dois empregos. De manhã, faço rádio a minha responsabilidade é apresentar seis programas por semana e tenho, tenho que me dar ao trabalho de estar ao par das notícias porque eu faço alguns programas de música e outros programas são de, de talk por tanto faço uma abordagem de assuntos de atualidade, incorporo opiniões, isto na rádio porque não faço notícias.*

I: Well, I have two jobs. In the morning, I do radio, my responsibility is to present six programs per week and I have, I have to dedicate myself to the job, to be aware of the news because I do some music programs, and other programs are talk shows therefore I do an overview of the current news, I incorporate opinions, this is a radio talk show because I don't broadcast news.

The second part of our hypothesis is related to possible correlations between language attitudes and social networks. Do positive linguistic attitudes towards the minority language correlate positively to all the social network domains in the same way? In order to investigate this part of our hypothesis, which assumes that positive attitudes towards one's own language are positively correlated to social network domains, Pearson's correlation coefficients were calculated between language attitudes and each of the domains: family, friends, work, church and school. Table 6 shows the different correlations between the variables.

Table 6. Pearson’s correlation coefficients between language attitudes and social networks

Participants	Attitudes to Portuguese	Family	Friends	Work	Church	School
PF7	4	3	3		4	3
PF10	4	3.7	4	4	1	
PF12	5	2.3	1	1	3	3
PF13	5	4.4	4	4	4	
PM9	5	4.3	4	4	4	4
PF9	4	2.1	2	3	3	3
PM10	4	2.4	1	1	1	2
PM6	4	3	4	4	4	4
PM2	4	2.6	3	4	3	1
Pearson correlation r α% 5		0.505	0.065	−0.076	0.402	0.410

Results presented in Table 6 show that not all social network domains correlate in the same way with the positive attitudes that participants declare toward their minority language. Following Evans’s (1996) guide for the absolute value of *r*, we conclude that none of them show a strong correlation.¹¹ Family, church and school have moderate correlation; friends have very weak correlation while work has a negative correlation.

Family domain is indeed one of the most important environments for language maintenance as it provides the necessary interactions to learn the language and the culture of a minority group. Moreover, family can help foster positive attitudes towards language. These positive attitudes can lead to linguistic maintenance and can avoid attrition and shift toward the majority language as can be seen in the following example of a second-generation speaker of Portuguese.

I: *A pergunta que me fazem com mais frequência mas uhh foi em casa, sempre falei português em casa, os meus avós foram um grande fator nesse sentido mas para além disso o gosto de falar e querer aperfeiçoar e aprender sempre, não é. Escrever, uhh, eu, eu gostava por exemplo eu gostava de pegar no jornal português e tentar ler o que estava aliquando eu era mais novinho e no conhecimento da língua e tentava a ler o que estava ali. A partir dali eu também, pus-me a escrever, pronto quase que me obriguei a aprender mas não contra à vontade ...*

I: It’s the question that I’m asked quite often but uhh, it was at home, I always spoke Portuguese at home, my grandparents were a big influence in that respect but besides this, I liked to talk, and I wanted to perfect and learn always. To write,

11. According to Evans (1996) a range between .00 and .19 shows a very weak correlation; a range of .20 to .39 has a weak correlation; .40 to .59 is moderate; .60 to .70 is strong, and .80 to 1.00 is very strong.

uhh, I, I used to like for example, I liked to take the Portuguese newspaper and try to read what was there...when I was younger and I had a better understanding of the language I would attempt to read what was there. From then on I also began to write, I pretty much forced myself to learn but not against my will....

When we take a closer look at the correlation between the family domain and linguistic attitudes we observe different correlation patterns with each family member.

Table 7. Pearson's correlation coefficients between language attitudes and family members

Attitudes toward Portuguese	Mother	Father	Both	Grandparents	Siblings	Relatives
Pearson correlation	0	0.628	0.492	0.082	0.755	0.585
r α % 5						

The data in Table 7 suggests different correlation patterns; however, these results are not exhaustive due to the limited data. Additionally, we must remember that correlation does not mean causation. A positive correlation between two variables X and Y means that the variable Y increases as X increases. The correlation coefficient is negative if X and Y tend to lie on opposite sides: as one increases the other decreases; and the stronger the tendency, the larger is the absolute value of the correlation coefficient. A value of *zero* or close to *zero* implies that there is no linear correlation between the variables.

While positive linguistic attitudes are important to encourage ethnic language use and foster linguistic socialization, the results of our data do not demonstrate any correlation between positive attitudes and relationship with the mothers and grandparents of the participants: they are independent of each other. Mothers and grandparents show almost absolute values since all of our participants claimed that they were very important in helping them to maintain their Portuguese language and rated them 5 out of 5. As the covariance between the variables is 0 or close to 0, the Pearson correlation coefficient – obtained by dividing the covariance by the product of their standard deviation – is also close to 0, evidencing the independence of both variables: positive language attitudes and use of Portuguese with mothers and grandparents.

Our analysis suggests the strongest correlation exists between language attitudes and fathers rather than mothers and grandparents. There is also a moderate correlation with both parents when they are both present in a conversation. Many studies have highlighted the influence that mothers have in language maintenance; and have suggested “the gendered nature of intergenerational transmission” of language (Velázquez, 2012, p. 199). Okita (2001) also found that the responsibility to encourage children's bilingualism fell upon mothers rather than fathers. While

our study does not contradict these findings (our results simply do not show any correlations between language attitudes and the importance of speaking Portuguese with mothers), our study does highlight the importance that fathers also have on the formation of positive linguistic attitudes that will ultimately benefit language maintenance. Moreover, as Kroskrity (2000) states, identity construction is complete through the use of both particular language choices as well as communicative practices. Our results also confirm that language practices at home when involving the ethnic language have a positive correlation in forming favorable linguistic attitudes toward the minority language.

This study also demonstrates that there is a positive correlation between favorable language attitudes and the use of Portuguese with relatives. According to Hulsen et al. (2002), relatives are an important factor that influences linguistic maintenance. Language practices and choosing Portuguese as the primary language to talk with siblings are also significant factors and show a strong correlation with positive language attitudes. Families who live in the home country allow immigrants the opportunity to frequently connect with the culture while simultaneously offering them the opportunity to speak with native speakers of their language.

Conclusions

The goal of this paper was to examine the relationship among language attitudes, social networks and language maintenance. A combination of questionnaires, the ethnolinguistic vitality method and the social network theory along with sociolinguistic interviews were used to determine speakers' attitudes and their impact on language maintenance. The study included first and second-generation speakers of Portuguese living in New England who have maintained their common traditions and language.

The results of our data show that both positive attitudes as well as supportive social networks have contributed to language maintenance and the ethnolinguistic vitality of the Portuguese language among first and second-generation speakers. In the Portuguese diaspora of New England, it is seen that first-generation Portuguese speakers have reconstructed their sense of belonging by supporting traditions, Portuguese businesses, and building places of worship. Thus, in this effortless way, first-generation speakers convey the importance of language maintenance to those speakers of second-generation. As a result, Portuguese has been considered a high vitality language which means that speakers are capable of maintaining their language and culture in a multilingual setting.

An analysis of the data indicates that first and second-generation speakers have positive attitudes in regards to their minority language and claim to

be highly-proficient in Portuguese and as a result they were able to maintain a one-hour interview in Portuguese, regardless of their level of language proficiency. Moreover, the same social networks that have helped to maintain the ethnic language among first-generation immigrants are not the same for second-generation speakers, and therefore, the first null hypothesis that led this study must be rejected. First-generation speakers maintain strong bonds with the community differently than second-generation speakers. Despite this distinction, second-generation speakers of Portuguese have a high usage of Portuguese in almost all of the domains for education has permitted them to hold oral maintenance and print literacy in the minority language. Although first generation speakers have decreased in terms of language use in some domains, it slightly increased amongst second-generation speakers.

Regarding the second hypothesis of this research (positive linguistic attitudes towards one's language are related to the use of Portuguese within all social domains), the null hypothesis must also be rejected. While a positive correlation was observed between favorable language attitudes and the social domains of family, church and school, the correlation was weak within the domain of friends and a negative correlation was observed between language attitudes and work. Furthermore, when analyzing the strong correlation displayed between family and linguistic attitudes, we perceive different patterns among different family members.

Although the sample of the corpora under scrutiny is limited, we have observed that there is a correlation between positive attitudes towards one's own minority language and language use in some domains. Thus, we conclude that linguistic attitudes continue to be a key factor in preventing language loss and promoting ethnic pride, which will ultimately benefit language maintenance.

Despite the difficulties that this community experienced, their members were able to maintain their language, and all of the participants in this research recognized the importance of the Portuguese language as a key role in maintaining their identity.

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